

— April - June —
2026 Edition

Q2 2026 Newsletter



Building Momentum for Sustainable Impact

The second quarter of 2026 has been a period of remarkable growth, innovation, and advocacy for Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization. Through strategic partnerships, capacity strengthening, youth engagement, and national advocacy, we continued advancing our mission of improving the lives of individuals and families affected by sickle cell disease.

****APRIL HIGHLIGHTS****

Strengthening Our
Social Enterprise
Capacity

****MAY HIGHLIGHTS****

Launch of University
Genotype Screening
Programme

****JUNE HIGHLIGHTS****

World Sickle Cell Day
2026: Closing the
Survival Gap

Strengthening Our Social Enterprise Capacity



Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization was honored to be selected among twelve outstanding organizations to participate in the Entrepreneurial Skills Training under the Kisumu Cohort, organized by **The Giving Exchange (TGE)**.

This opportunity represents an important milestone in strengthening our sustainability journey by equipping our team with practical skills to build a resilient social enterprise that will generate long-term impact for the sickle cell community.

During the intensive training, our team completed seven key modules covering:

- * Introduction to Social Enterprise
- * Business Model Development
- * Financial Management and Sustainability
- * Marketing and Branding Strategies
- * Impact Measurement and Reporting
- * Leadership and Organizational Development
- * Pitching and Investor Readiness



The training has strengthened our capacity to diversify resources, improve organizational sustainability, and expand services to individuals living with sickle cell disease.

We sincerely appreciate tuIFUND for connecting us with The Giving Exchange and investing in grassroots organizations that are transforming communities.



On 8 May 2026, **Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization** successfully launched the pilot Voluntary Sickle Cell Genotype Screening, Counseling, Education and Awareness Programme for university students at Jaramogi Oginga Odinga University of Science and Technology (JOOUST).

The initiative was implemented through a collaborative partnership with AMPATH Kenya, Innovative Hematology Inc., Dr. Sam Mbunya Health & Leadership Consultancy, Matibabu Hospital, and Silverlake Research Company/HemotypeCS.

The programme seeks to:

- * Increase awareness of sickle cell disease among young people.
- * Promote voluntary genotype screening.
- * Encourage informed reproductive health decisions.
- * Generate evidence to support policy advocacy for genetic screening in Kenya.

One of the most memorable moments of the event was a captivating performance by the JOOUST Drama Team, which challenged misconceptions that sickle cell disease is caused by witchcraft. Through drama and storytelling, the students encouraged communities to embrace scientific knowledge, seek appropriate healthcare, and reject stigma.

We extend our appreciation to the leadership of JOOUST, particularly Prof. George Ayodo, for hosting the event and mobilizing students to participate in the screening exercise.

Following the successful pilot, Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization is expanding this initiative to universities across Western Kenya to empower more young people with knowledge of their genotype and contribute to healthier future generations.



World Sickle Cell Day 2026: Closing the Survival Gap

On 19 June 2026, Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization proudly participated in the national commemoration of World Sickle Cell Day at Bunyala TVET in Busia County under the global theme:

“Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease.”

The event brought together government leaders, healthcare professionals, development partners, caregivers, advocates, and individuals living with sickle cell disease to champion equitable access to quality healthcare.

The Principal Secretary for Medical Services, Dr. Ouma Oluga, served as the Chief Guest and reaffirmed the Government of Kenya’s commitment to Universal Health Coverage and improving access to quality healthcare services for people living with sickle cell disease.

Integrated services offered during the event included:

- * Voluntary blood donation
- * Free sickle cell genotype screening
- * General health and wellness checks
- * Social Health Authority (SHA) registration
- * National ID registration
- * Nutrition education for sickle cell disease management

The celebration also featured inspiring drama, poetry, songs, and community performances that helped dispel myths surrounding sickle cell disease while promoting inclusion, awareness, and hope.

The event was made possible through collaboration between the Ministry of Health and numerous partners, including Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization, the Sickle Cell Federation of Kenya, Children Sickle Cell Foundation, NCD Alliance Kenya, TERUMO, SickleScan, Afya Dhabiti PEN-Plus, AMPATH, Novartis, and Fondation Pierre Fabre.

As Tumaini Sickle Cell Organization, we were proud to contribute to the planning and successful implementation of this historic national event. We remain committed to advocating for policies and partnerships that ensure every person living with sickle cell disease has equitable access to early diagnosis, quality healthcare, life-saving treatment, and the opportunity to thrive.



Looking Ahead :

The achievements of this quarter reflect our continued commitment to strengthening organizational capacity, promoting early diagnosis through genotype screening, empowering communities with accurate information, and influencing policy for equitable healthcare.

As we move into the second half of 2026, we remain focused on expanding university screening programmes, strengthening partnerships, advancing sustainable social enterprise initiatives, and amplifying the voices of people living with sickle cell disease.

Together, we are closing the survival gap and creating a future where every person living with sickle cell disease can live a healthier, longer, and more dignified life.
Together, we are turning hope into action and action into lasting impact.

Upcoming Events



Launch of the **Nutri Care For Dignity project** in partnership with The Giving Exchange and Jaramogi Oginga Odinga University of Science and Technology

Contact us on :

☎ 0715873713
✉ info@tumainisicklecell.org

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